

FUGUE 23**B MAJOR (FOUR VOICES).**

Exposition.—The subject of this fugue, which is in the tenor—



could have been given a real answer, but Bach has elected to regard the second, third, fourth and fifth notes in their relation to the dominant, and answer them by the corresponding intervals of the tonic, thus giving a **tonal** answer, somewhat as in No. 19. The answer is in the alto, accompanied by a countersubject in the tenor. A peculiarity of this fugue, however, is that the countersubject is regular throughout the exposition only, being subsequently used only once in a complete form (bars 31, 32), all other later entries being accompanied either by mere fragments of the countersubject, or by counterpoint principally derived, in rhythm, from its first seven notes. The treble enters with the subject in bar 5, and the bass with the answer in bar 7. A codetta (to bar 11) is followed by a redundant entry in the tenor in the original key.

Middle Section.—The episodes (bars 13 to 16, first quaver, and 26 to 29, first quaver) are founded in part on the semiquaver figure of the countersubject, and are not very important. The subject appears in the alto in bar 16, in the key of F sharp. In bar 18 it is given in the treble, by inverse movement, in the key of B, answered in the alto in F sharp, also by inverse movement. The bass then gives it in its original form, and the tenor (from bar 24) in C sharp minor, commencing on the mediant, and slightly ornamented at the end.

Final Section.—The final entries—subject in alto (bar 29) and answer in treble (bar 31) are perfectly straightforward.

FUGUE 24

B MINOR (FOUR VOICES).

A worthy close to the first part of the work. The striking chromatic subject—



commencing in the tonic key closes in the dominant, and in order to return to the tonic in the answer, and at the same time to preserve the characteristic intervals and the sequence, it was necessary to make the **tonal** change very early. The fifth note, therefore, as well as the first, is answered by the tonic, and the whole answer from this point is a fifth below the subject. The case is analogous to that of No. 18.

Exposition.—The subject is announced by the alto. The answer is in the tenor, and is accompanied by a countersubject from the fourth beat of bar 4. A codetta of two bars, in almost strict canon, derived from the countersubject, is followed by the subject in the bass (bar 9), and this, after another bar of codetta, by the answer in the treble (bar 13). The entry of the subject in bar 21 in the alto can best be described as a redundant entry, being still in the original key, and giving the treble its first opportunity of taking the countersubject. The first episode (bars 16 to 21) also clearly belongs to the first section of the fugue, as it does not quit the original keys.